Snapdragon SM6475Q is a six-core part clocked up to 2.4GHz. It is not silicon for heavy photo workflows, serious video editing or dozens of demanding apps fighting for memory. In the reference review, the OmniPad posted a Geekbench 6 multi-score that trailed the Dimensity 7300-Ultra-based Oppo Pad 5 and the OnePlus Pad Go 2. But synthetic comparisons can obscure what this product is actually good at.

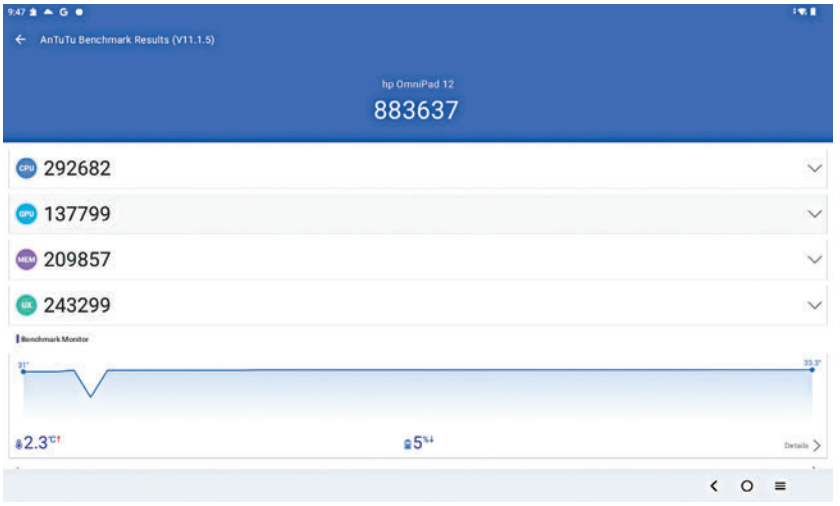
The OmniPad 12's processor may not be the best-in-class, but it's good enough for its intended use – taking notes, typing on documents, attending video meetings, listening to music, and watching videos. Onboard speakers are alright, loud enough to get the job done, but headphones are better. Streaming videos on YouTube, Netflix and chill works just fine, in between work commitments on the OmniPad 12. Battery life is just under two days, if not more, if you only use it for browsing websites, writing emails and typing out on Google Docs – no video calls, YouTube or music – as I found out while using it on a work trip from Mumbai to Bengaluru and back, which was probably the most impressive experience of the OmniPad 12, to be honest.

That battery experience is the strongest reason to consider the OmniPad over a conventional budget Windows machine. HP rates it for up to 18 hours under its own video-playback



test, and you can easily expect it to last a full day of work-mode or college-mode usage. The 31Wh battery, Android and modest Snapdragon hardware ensure the HP OmniPad 12 performs well in terms of endurance.

There are a few compromises on the HP OmniPad 12. Despite being a tablet, its cameras are more functional than memorable, whether it's the 8MP selfie camera for video calls or rear camera for photography. Connectivity is basic, there's only a single USB-C port, headphone/mic combo and microSD slot. If you're a compulsive multitasker with more than 7-8 apps open at the same time, the OmniPad can remind you quickly that it is still closer to a mainstream Android tablet than a full-fledged ultrabook. So, keep that in mind.



A Chromebook-shaped idea

Overall, the HP OmniPad 12 isn't just a tablet with a dedicated keypad case with a kickstand, it's a great budget laptop consideration if you want something thin, light, with great battery life for taking notes in college classrooms or working on-the-go.

In fact, the more I think about it, the more it feels to me like a Chromebook when you use it as a laptop, with the added bonus of a fully-functional tablet you can switch to whenever you don't need to use it in typing mode. It may not have the fastest chip, but it's not a slouch, and the OmniPad 12's versatility is its greatest asset – be a tablet-Chromebook hybrid which gives it the ability to morph into a laptop for basic typing, apart from being a full-fledged Android tablet.

That is the lens through which the OmniPad 12 makes sense, when you weigh its strengths and compromises. Calling it a laptop replacement isn't correct, as it will only invite disappointment. But at the same time, calling it a tablet with a keyboard also understates it. This is a compact Android work machine for people whose "serious" computing is mostly browser-based.

Students are an obvious audience. So are writers, salespeople, frequent travellers and professionals whose road kit is dominated by documents, email, presentations, meetings and media. The display is sharper than what many entry-level laptops offer, the detachable design gives it flexibility a clamshell cannot match, and the battery can be genuinely liberating.

Would I trade a MacBook Air or a capable Windows ultrabook for it? No. Would I take the OmniPad 12 on a short trip where my workload ends at Docs, Chrome, email, meetings and Netflix?

And that distinction matters. The OmniPad 12 does not win by becoming a better laptop. It wins whenever you realise you did not need to carry a full laptop in the first place.